

GUNJAN SHAH

Journalist and Communications Professional

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Journalist and communications professional with five years across digital journalism, SEO content, social media and sports PR. In Galway: PR Officer for Connacht Cricket Union (about 20 press releases a month for 9 clubs), Social Media Manager for University of Galway Cricket Club (Instagram followers up from about 125 to 403), and journalist at Galway Pulse, SAAI 2024 Student Media Outlet of the Year. Earlier in Mumbai: 50+ stories read by 500,000+ readers at Republic World and Tata Housing's social media at Thought in a Dot. MA Journalism, University of Galway. Open to content, communications, PR and social media roles in Ireland.

KEY SKILLS

Writing and PR. Press releases and media relations, copywriting, SEO articles, editing and proofreading, newsletters, influencer outreach.

Social media. Instagram, Facebook and LinkedIn through Meta Business Suite, with reporting from Google Analytics and each platform's own insights. Google Trends and Keyword Planner for research.

Design and publishing. Canva, Photoshop, Premiere Pro and Audition. WordPress and Substack. Basic HTML.

Everyday tools. Excel, PowerPoint and Google Workspace, plus Claude, ChatGPT and Gemini for drafting and research.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Public Relations Officer

Jan 2026 to present

Connacht Cricket Union (voluntary)

Galway, Ireland

- Write every press release the Union sends to regional media, around 20 a month, covering its 9 member clubs.
- Act as the main contact between the Union, Cricket Ireland and regional media, keeping one consistent message from national body to club level.
- Run the Union's Facebook and Instagram channels, from content planning and publishing to monthly performance reports.
- Produced social content for the It's Wicket Schools Programme and Connacht cricket milestones.

Social Media Manager

Sept 2024 to present

University of Galway Cricket Club (voluntary)

Galway, Ireland

- Grew the club's Instagram from about 125 to 403 followers (roughly 3x) and raised posting from 0.9 to 2.6 posts a month (16 posts in 18 months before, 63 in about 24 months since).
- Lifted median post reach 18%, from 1,413 to 1,673 accounts. The National Cup 2026 squad announcement reached 2,784 accounts.
- Arranged a collab reel with four other accounts that reached 16,711 accounts.
- Plan posts across three platforms around match days, club milestones and sponsor commitments. Design every match-day post, campaign announcement and award graphic in Canva, and film Instagram Stories during matches.
- Developed the teaser video campaign for the club's October 2026 indoor tennis-ball tournament, from concept and storyboard through Canva production and two rounds of review.

Journalist, Digital and Copy Editor

Jan to Apr 2024

Galway Pulse

Galway, Ireland

- Wrote, edited and proofread 10+ news stories a month for local and national audiences, including exclusives built on interviews with residents, businesses and city officials.
- Added on-page SEO to every story before it went live on WordPress. Online visibility rose 25%.
- Ran the outlet's social media accounts and kept every post in one consistent design.

Senior Content Writer and Account Manager

Mar to Dec 2022

Thought in a Dot

Mumbai, India

- Planned content for 3+ campaigns that went on to win awards, for real estate, beauty, health and lifestyle clients. #CelebrateLife was recognised at the IMAGEXX Awards 2023.
- Handled Tata Housing's social media posts and influencer outreach.

- Supervised 3 junior writers and interns alongside day-to-day client account work.
- Grew audience interaction 30% with graphics and video made in Canva, Photoshop and Premiere Pro. Market reach rose 15% once social media data was used to steer content towards what audiences engaged with.

Editorial Research Specialist

Jun 2021 to Mar 2022

Gracenote (Nielsen)

Mumbai, India

- Edited and quality-checked metadata for 100+ podcasts from the UK, Canada, Australia and the US, verifying titles, cast and descriptions at source across 1,000+ episodes against daily accuracy and volume targets.
- Flagged a recurring host-credit error on a weekly Australian podcast and worked with the software team on a fix at source. Errors across my projects then fell 10%.

Journalist and SEO Content Writer

Aug 2019 to Mar 2020

Republic Media Group (Republic World)

Mumbai, India

- Published 50+ entertainment and tech stories that reached 500,000+ readers.
- Picked viral and breaking stories with content supervisors using Google Trends and Google Keyword Planner.
- Article visibility rose 35%+ through SEO on headlines, metadata and structure. Social shares rose 25% as tone and format were adapted to each audience.

INDEPENDENT PUBLISHING

Founder and Editor

2025 to present

Ink & Byline (Substack and WordPress)

Independent

- Write, edit and publish a fortnightly publication on film, TV, food and Galway culture, with 2,000+ reads and 72 subscribers (about 3.5% conversion) and no paid promotion.

Author, Musings and More

2019

Blue Rose Publishers

Self-published

- Published a bilingual poetry anthology.

ACADEMIC PROJECTS

Producer and Presenter, Drive-time Radio Show

2023 to 2024

Flirt FM, University of Galway

- Produced and presented a 30-minute live drive-time show with live and recorded interviews and news bulletins, scripting, recording and editing each segment.

TV News Bulletin (Group Production)

2023 to 2024

MA Journalism, University of Galway

- Shot and edited b-roll, vox pops and interviews for a 20-minute bulletin, scripted segments and ran the teleprompter for the anchors.

EDUCATION

MA Journalism, University of Galway, Ireland

2023 to 2024

MA Communication and Journalism, University of Mumbai

2018 to 2020

Bachelor of Mass Media (BMM), K.J. Somaiya College of Arts and Commerce, University of Mumbai

2015 to 2018

AWARDS AND CERTIFICATIONS

- Student Media Outlet of the Year, SAAI 2024, as part of the Galway Pulse newsroom
- Website of the Year and Best Use of Social Media (Gold)
- Invaluable Member, University of Galway Cricket Club
- #CelebrateLife campaign recognised at the IMAGEXX Awards 2023, Thought in a Dot

Certifications. UX Writing Fundamentals. Pivoting Your Career to User Experience. HubSpot Email Marketing (in progress).

LANGUAGES

English, Hindi and Gujarati (native or bilingual). Marathi (professional working). Irish and Japanese (elementary).